

SOP-FORK-1300: Powered Industrial Truck (Forklift) Operations

Document owner: Warehouse Operations **Effective date:** 2024-02-01 **Review cycle:** 24 months

Section 1. Purpose and Scope

Governs operation, inspection, and operator certification for powered industrial trucks (forklifts, pallet jacks, order pickers).

Section 2. Operator Certification

Clause 2.1 — Only personnel holding current facility certification for the specific truck type/class may operate it; certification lapses after 36 months or immediately following any at-fault incident, whichever comes first.

Clause 2.2 — An operator involved in an at-fault incident shall be re-evaluated and re-certified before resuming operation of any powered industrial truck.

Section 3. Pre-Shift Inspection

Clause 3.1 — A documented pre-shift inspection (brakes, steering, forks, mast, horn, lights, and — for LP/propane trucks — fuel system) is mandatory before first use each shift.

Clause 3.2 — Any deficiency affecting safe operation removes the truck from service immediately; it shall be tagged out and not returned to service until repaired and re-inspected.

Section 4. Load Limits

Clause 4.1 — Rated capacity is per the truck's data plate at the load's actual center of gravity; capacity shall never be assumed at a load center other than what the data plate specifies without recalculation.

Section 5. Pedestrian Safety

Clause 5.1 — Designated pedestrian walkways shall be maintained clear of truck travel paths where facility layout permits; where a shared path is unavoidable, the truck has the right of way only when its horn has been sounded and pedestrian clearance confirmed.

Section 6. Records

Clause 6.1 — Pre-shift inspection logs and operator certification records are filed to the Warehouse Operations File and retained for 3 years.